AR-05 Pediatric Airway

CLAIBORNE COUNTY EMS | MEDICAL-DIRECTOR APPROVED | SOURCE PDF | OCTOBER 17, 2026

Scope: Infant or child after the newly born period with actual or threatened airway obstruction, inadequate oxygenation or ventilation, or inability to protect the airway. Use the length-based pediatric system for equipment and medication support.

Field flow

1. Basic first	Neutral position, suction, age-appropriate OPA/NPA, and two-person age-sized BVM with PEEP when indicated.
2. Support	Oxygen, BVM, authorized BIAD, and Paramedic ETT only when clinically necessary.
3. Rescue	If oxygenation/ventilation is ineffective, move immediately to AR-06 Pediatric Failed Airway.
4. Confirm	Waveform EtCO2 after ETT/BIAD, chest exam, depth, SpO2, securement, warmth, and transport.

Provider-level actions

Level	Approved actions
EMT	Position, suction, basic adjuncts, age-appropriate BVM, warmth, and length-based system. Do not delay transport solely to place an advanced airway.
AEMT	All EMT care plus authorized pediatric BIAD, vascular access, and waveform capnography. ETT is not an AEMT procedure in this protocol.
Paramedic	All prior care plus ETT when necessary and likely to succeed, chest decompression when indicated, and rare age-appropriate surgical rescue only when specifically authorized.

AR-05 Pediatric Airway

SAFETY, MEDICATION, AND LINKED-PATHWAY REFERENCE

Safety and escalation

• For inadequate breathing with a pulse, ventilate one breath every 2-3 seconds (20-30/min) with visible chest rise; use EtCO2 when available.

• Limit laryngoscopy to three total attempts. Each later attempt must change provider, approach, position, or equipment; move immediately to AR-06 when ineffective.

• Effective BVM is often safer than a difficult pediatric intubation.

• Pediatric DAI requires a direct online Claiborne EMS Medical Director or Assistant Medical Director order.

Linked pathways

AO-02 Newly Born; AR-06 Pediatric Failed Airway; AR-08 Post-Intubation / BIAD Management; PC-02 Pediatric Bradycardia / Poor Perfusion.

Source control

• This controlled direct source PDF replaces the prior source file and matches approved Claiborne EMS app content released October 17, 2026.

• Use current Claiborne standing orders, formulary, equipment authorization, and Medical Control direction whenever they govern a case-specific decision.